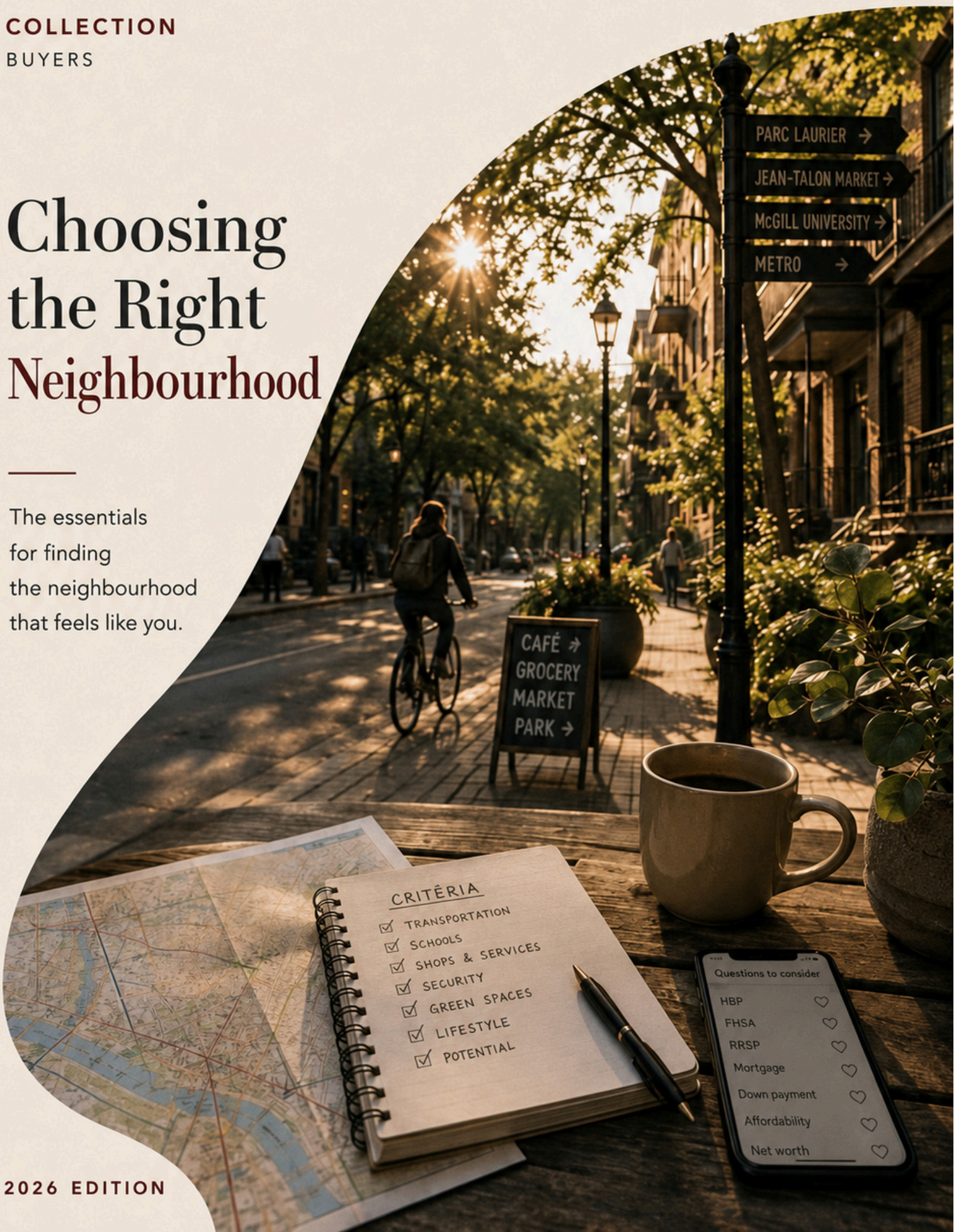
Signé PAR Em

№. 11

COLLECTION
BUYERS

Choosing the Right Neighbourhood

The essentials for finding the neighbourhood that feels like you.



2026 EDITION

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Important notice

This guide is provided for informational and educational purposes only. It presents general information about real estate in Quebec and does not constitute personalized real estate, legal, tax or financial advice. Every real estate situation is different, and you should consult the appropriate professionals before making a decision about a transaction.

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COLLECTION BUYERS · GUIDE NO. 11

Choosing the Right Neighbourhood

Laval and the North Shore — find the area that fits your life

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You can renovate everything in a house, except its location. Choosing the right neighborhood in Laval or on the North Shore means protecting your quality of life AND the resale value of your property.

This guide gives you a method for evaluating a sector: transportation, services, schools, development, atmosphere and resale - applied to the realities of Laval, Terrebonne, Repentigny, Blainville, Mirabel and surrounding areas.

Each chapter ends with a lined “My Notes” page to compare your favorite sectors.

“Location, location, location”: the neighborhood weighs as much as the property on your quality of life and your resale. This guide gives you an objective method to compare the sectors of Greater Montreal, from Laval to the North Shore.

The idea: replace your favorite with a grid of criteria - then validate in the field before committing.

CHAPTER

The method of evaluating a neighborhood

> *Equip yourself with an objective grid rather than a favorite.*

A good neighborhood is not judged only by its pretty street. Evaluate each sector on concrete criteria and weight them according to YOUR reality (family, teleworking, transport).

- Travel: access to highways (15, 25, 440, 640), bridges, commuter train, real time to your work during rush hours.
- Local services: grocery stores, pharmacies, clinics, shops, leisure activities.
- Schools and daycares: proximity, reputation, capacity.
- Security and tranquility: traffic, noise, street atmosphere.
- Development: upcoming projects that can improve (or densify) the sector.

Rate each sector on concrete criteria: proximity to work and transport, schools, shops, security, noise, development projects and resale potential. An objective grid prevents you from paying a premium for a pretty street whose daily life will not suit you.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Test commuting at actual rush hour, not on a Sunday. In Laval and on the North Shore, a 15-minute difference on a bridge can change your daily life for years.*

CHAPTER

Laval: very different faces

> *Understand the diversity of Laval sectors.*

Laval is not a uniform block: mature and well-served areas (close to metro stations and major roads) rub shoulders with more recent, family-run developments on the outskirts. Prices, atmosphere and type of building vary greatly from one neighborhood to another.

- Proximity to the metro and major centers: convenience and resale.
- Recent family sectors: new houses, schools, but sometimes services still under development.
- Waterfront and established areas: character and stability, often at a premium.

In Laval, the reality changes from one sector to another: proximity to metro stations and major roads, mature neighborhoods vs. recent developments, access to services. Price and lifestyle vary greatly - hence the importance of targeting the sector, not just the city.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *In Laval, ask yourself if you want the convenience of a mature sector or the space of a recent development. Both are valid - but they don't attract the same buyer at resale.*

CHAPTER

The North Shore: suburban space and life

> *Weigh the appeal of the northern crowns.*

Terrebonne, Mascouche, Repentigny, Blainville, Boisbriand, Sainte-Thérèse, Mirabel: the North Shore often offers more space for the price, a family setting and nature - at the cost, sometimes, of a longer commute to Montreal.

- Advantages: larger houses, land, family atmosphere, recent developments.
- To consider: distance and travel time, dependence on cars, services depending on the sector.
- Commuter trains and highways greatly change the appeal of an area.

The North Shore (Terrebonne, Mascouche, Repentigny, Blainville, Boisbriand, Sainte-Thérèse, Mirabel) often offers more space for the money, at the cost of a longer commute. Weigh the daily transportation time, access to services and school offerings according to your stage of life.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *On the North Shore, access to structuring transportation (train, highway) is a major value factor. A well-connected sector sells better than an isolated sector, at the same price.*

CHAPTER

Think about resale from the moment of purchase

> *Choose a neighborhood that will protect your investment.*

The neighborhood that you like must also please your future buyer. The sought-after sectors (good transport, good schools, services, low nuisance) resell faster and better, even in a slower market.

Be wary of elements that are difficult to change and which slow down resale: busy street, proximity to a nuisance (noise, industry), flooding of certain sectors. A good price does not always compensate for a permanent handicap.

The neighborhood that you like must also please your future buyer: the sought-after areas (transport, renowned schools, services) sell better and are resistant to declines. Buying with resale in mind means protecting your bet even if your plans change.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Buy the neighborhood as much as the house. The most beautiful property in a declining area is a worse investment than an ordinary house in a sought-after area.*

CHAPTER

Test a neighborhood before committing

> *Validate in the field, not just on paper.*

A neighborhood is not judged solely by statistics. Before buying, please **live** a little:

- Visit at **different times** (morning, evening, weekend).
- Test it **journey** to work or school during peak hours.
- Locate **shops, transport, parks** and daily services.
- Observe the**atmosphere** and maintenance of neighboring properties.

These concrete verifications reveal what no descriptive sheet says.

Nothing replaces the field: visit at different times, test the commute to work during rush hour, observe the maintenance of the neighborhood. Twenty minutes on Sunday can become fifty on Tuesday. We buy a daily newspaper, not just an address.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Travel to work at rush hour before buying, not on Sunday at noon. Twenty minutes on Sunday can become fifty on Tuesday. We also buy a daily newspaper, not just an address.*

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

> *Your next steps, concretely.*

This week

1. Establish my weighted criteria grid.
2. Test real-life commutes to work during rush hour.

Within 30 days

1. Visit my 2-3 favorite areas at different times (week/evening/weekend).
2. Check schools, services and development projects.

Then

1. Ask Emilie for the resale history and dynamics of my target sectors.

To choose my sector

1. Build my criteria grid and note each neighborhood visited.
2. Test the daily route and visit at different times before offering.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Criteria grid: tool for objectively evaluating a sector.
- Structural transport: commuter train, metro, major routes which support value.
- Mature vs. recent sector: established convenience vs. space and new.
- Resale: capacity of a neighborhood to attract future buyers.
- Permanent handicap: non-modifiable nuisance which weighs on value.
- Month of inventory: indicator of local market tension.
- Commuting: travel time between home and work, to be tested during peak hours.
- Resale potential: ease of resale depending on the lasting appeal of the sector.
- Local services: shops, schools, transport, health, leisure.
- Development project: project or plan that could change the value of a sector.

GO FURTHER

Quiz - test yourself

1. What we cannot renovate is:

A) The kitchen

B) Location

C) The roof

D) Painting

2. To evaluate the movements, you must test:

A) A Sunday

B) The actual journey during rush hour

C) At night

D) Never

3. Laval is characterized by:

A) Only one type of neighborhood

B) Very different sectors (mature vs recent)

C) No school

D) No metro

4. A typical advantage of the North Shore is:

A) Less space

B) More space for the price

C) No nature

D) No development

5. On the North Shore, a major value factor is:

A) The color of the houses

B) Access to structuring transport (train, highway)

C) The name of the street

D) The maximum distance

6. Thinking about resale means choosing a neighborhood that will appeal to:

A) Only me

B) Also to my future buyer

C) To no one

D) To the seller

7. A permanent handicap to watch out for is:

A) A beautiful view

B) A busy street or a nuisance

C) A park

D) A school

8. The best approach is to purchase:

A) The house only

B) The neighborhood as much as the house

C) Random

D) The most beautiful house regardless of the area

Answers

1. B - Location is the king criterion (intro and chapter 4).

2. B - Actual peak time is what matters (chap. 1).

3. B - The diversity of sectors is great (chap. 2).

4. B - Family space and environment (chap. 3).

5. B - Connectivity supports value (chap. 3).

6. B - Sought-after sectors sell better (chap. 4).

7. B - These elements slow down resale (chap. 4).

8. B - The sector protects the investment (chap. 4).

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You now have the right keys in hand.

Every real estate journey is different.

If you would like to go further,
I would be happy to discuss
your project with you.



Make informed decisions.
Choose with confidence.
Live without regrets.
See you soon,
Emilie ☺

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